

like most of those in this buyer group, he never neglected his family. He provided funds for his children's college tuitions in full and more. He and his family live in a fine home in an upper-middle-class neighborhood. In fact, about 80 percent of his group live in homes valued at \$300,000 to \$500,000.

Dr. Bill's goal always was to become financially independent, but he never wanted to become an entrepreneur. Often, entrepreneurs become wealthy by taking substantial risks and by leveraging the labor and talent of dozens, even hundreds, of others. Dr. Bill was never cut out to be anything but a professor. He is not alone. *Most people in this country are not the entrepreneurial type. But this does not mean that they can't become millionaires.*

People often confuse our message about the relationship between being wealthy and being an entrepreneur. We're not telling people to give up doing their own thing in medicine, law, accounting, and other occupations and join the ranks of the entrepreneurs in this country. Don't even consider such a change unless you really want to and are fully capable of succeeding. If you can generate a reasonably good income—say, twice the norm for households in America, or \$65,000 to \$70,000—then you may become wealthy one day if you follow the defensive strategy developed by millionaires who are used vehicle-prone shoppers.

Most of Dr. Bill's nonmillionaire neighbors have no household budget. They do no consumption planning. As a result, they have no restrictions on their domestic expenditures except one—the upper limits of their income. Yet these are the very types who are prone to whisper criticisms about frugal neighbors such as Dr. Bill.

Mr. Norman is an executive who lives in a \$400,000 home in Dr. Bill's neighborhood. His household income last year was in excess of \$150,000. But he has next to zero invested in anything other than home equity, motor vehicles, and a corporate pension plan. Mr. Norman's household has a net worth of under \$200,000. Mr. Norman and his wife are each fifty years old. So are their neighbors, the used vehicle-prone shopper, Dr. Bill, and his wife. Bill earns only about half of what the Normans earn. But Bill's household has a net worth that is nine times greater than the Normans. Can this be possible?

It's more than possible. It is probable and predictable. *Great offense and poor defense translate into under accumulation of wealth.* But the Normans are not alone. There are many more under accumulators in their neighborhood than there are prodigious accumulators like Dr. Bill and his family.